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10 Nights on Norwegian Jewel: Solo Edition

Norwegian Jewel · 10 Nights from Miami

November 29 to December 9, 2027 · Sailing solo



Norwegian Jewel at anchor off George Town, Grand Cayman, in 2007, with a tender alongside. Your sailing anchors here on December 7. Photo: Kyle.died.rich, public domain, via Wikimedia Commons.

A Voyage Pack from **In the Wake**
Written for a solo traveler on this sailing

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Welcome

> *Made for someone sailing this cruise alone, who wants one plain read on the ten nights: the ship, the six stops, and what to check before you go.*

This pack is about one cruise: **Norwegian Jewel**, Norwegian Cruise Line, sailing 10 nights round trip from **Miami, Monday November 29 to Thursday December 9, 2027**. NCL calls it a “10-Day Caribbean Round-trip Miami: Curaçao, Aruba & Dominican Republic.” She calls at **Great Stirrup Cay, Cabo Rojo, Aruba, Curaçao, Falmouth and Grand Cayman**, with three sea days spread through the trip.

It’s written for someone sailing it **solo**. You don’t need a group to do this cruise well, and NCL has cabins on this ship built for one.

A note on what’s first-hand here and what isn’t

I haven’t sailed Norwegian Jewel. This pack comes from NCL’s own pages (its schedule for this exact sailing, its ship page, its deck plans, its FAQ and its press releases), PortMiami, and government, tourism and park pages for each stop. Where only a travel site had the answer, the pack says so. Where nobody had it, the pack says that too. The sources note at the end, and the fact-check file behind this pack, list what was checked.

Your cruise is more than a year away. Prices and policies here were checked in **October 2026**, and NCL changes some of them every year. Check them again when NCL opens your bookings, and again the month before you sail. Where this pack and the NCL app disagree, go with the app.

It is calm by design. No urgency, no upsell, no countdown timer. The site that produced this pack is independent: no cruise-line affiliations, no shore-excursion commissions, no display ads. (See our **affiliate disclosure**.)

A note on the season. NOAA’s National Hurricane Center says the Atlantic hurricane season runs June 1 to November 30. You sail on November 29, the second-to-last day of it. Storms are rare that late, but they do happen, so travel insurance still makes sense.

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Includes an Emergency Contacts section with a fillable handoff card to leave with one trusted person at home. When you sail alone, that person is your link to home. The companion app keeps the card on your phone, and it works offline once it's loaded.

If this is your first time sailing solo, the **solo cruising stories on this site** are worth a read before you go.

At a Glance

Ship	**Norwegian Jewel**, the first of NCL's Jewel class
Cruise line	Norwegian Cruise Line (NCL)
Size	93,502 gross tons (a measure of enclosed volume, not weight) · 965 ft (294 m) long · decks 4 to 15 on NCL's deck plans
Guests and crew	2,368 guests at two to a cabin, and 1,069 crew, per NCL's ship page. That's about 2.2 guests for every crew member
Built by	Meyer Werft, Papenburg, Germany. In service 2005. NCL lists her as refurbished in 2025
Departure port	**Miami**, PortMiami. PortMiami lists Terminal B as NCL's terminal; your eDocs name the terminal for your sailing
Itinerary	10 nights · Caribbean, round trip (NCL calls it Curaçao, Aruba & Dominican Republic)
Traveling	Solo
Currency aboard	US dollar

Ports of call

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These are the times on NCL's own schedule for this sailing (voyage 25386145), read October 2026. **They are ship's times. Check them in the NCL app before you sail.**

1. **Miami, Florida.** Board Monday November 29. Ship leaves 4:00 PM
2. **Great Stirrup Cay, Bahamas.** Tuesday November 30, 7:00 AM to 3:00 PM
3. **At sea.** Wednesday December 1
4. **Cabo Rojo, Dominican Republic.** Thursday December 2, 9:00 AM to 4:00 PM
5. **Aruba (Oranjestad).** Friday December 3, 11:00 AM to 8:00 PM
6. **Curaçao (Willemstad).** Saturday December 4, 7:00 AM to 7:00 PM
7. **At sea.** Sunday December 5
8. **Falmouth, Jamaica.** Monday December 6, 7:00 AM to 5:00 PM
9. **Grand Cayman (George Town).** Tuesday December 7, 7:00 AM to 5:00 PM
10. **At sea.** Wednesday December 8
11. **Miami.** Arrive Thursday December 9, 7:00 AM

All aboard is one hour before the ship leaves. NCL's rule is that you must be back on board "no later than one (1) hour prior to the ship's scheduled departure time." So: 2:00 PM at Great Stirrup Cay, 3:00 PM at Cabo Rojo, 7:00 PM in Aruba, 6:00 PM in Curaçao, and 4:00 PM in Falmouth and Grand Cayman.

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Section 1 — Your Ship: Norwegian Jewel

The first of her class, freshened up in 2025

Norwegian Jewel was built by Meyer Werft in Papenburg, Germany, and finished in August 2005. She's the ship the Jewel class is named for. NCL's ship page lists her as refurbished in 2025, and an NCL press release from April 2026 mentions "the recently added Vibe Beach Club," NCL's adults-only sun deck.

Gross tonnage, 93,502 for her, measures the ship's enclosed volume, not her weight. Divide it by NCL's guest count and you get about 39 gross tons per guest. If you want to see how she compares with other ships, the **Ship Size Atlas** lines them up.

What's on board

These come from NCL's "What's On Board" page for Jewel. Line-ups can change by 2027, so check the app.

- **Included restaurants:** Azura and Tsar's Palace (the main dining rooms, Deck 6), the **Garden Café** buffet and **The Great Outdoors** (Deck 12), Topsiders Bar & Grill by the pool (Deck 12), and **O'Sheehan's** (Deck 8), which NCL lists as open 24 hours.
- **Specialty restaurants (extra): Cagney's Steakhouse**, **Moderno Churrascaria**, **La Cucina**, **Le Bistro**, **Teppanyaki**, **Chin Chin** and Sushi. NCL's page gives a cover charge of $40 to $60 a person, and its gratuity FAQ adds a 20% charge to specialty dining.

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- **Bars:** among others, **Maltings**, **Shaker's**, **Bliss Ultra Lounge**, the **Sugarcane Mojito Bar**, the Spinnaker Lounge, a **Sake Bar** and a **Starbucks**.
- **Shows** are in the Stardust Theater.
- **Pool, spa and fitness:** the Sapphire Pools on Deck 12, the Mandara Spa, and the Pulse Fitness Center. The spa's **Thermal Suite** is adults only and needs its own paid pass.
- **Vibe Beach Club** on Deck 14 is adults only and needs a paid pass.

What Jewel doesn't have

- **No Studio cabins and no Studio Lounge.** NCL lists Studios on ten ships, and Jewel isn't one of them. If you've read about NCL's solo lounge, that's on other ships.
- **No self-service laundry.** NCL's packing page says "laundry is not self-service." Fill in the order form in your cabin and your steward collects it. NCL offers express same-day service too. Prices are on the form.

Cabin choice: sailing solo

NCL sells **Solo Inside, Solo Oceanview and Solo Balcony** cabins, and its solo page lists Norwegian Jewel among the ships that have them. NCL says "double occupancy rates don't apply" in those cabins.

If you book a regular cabin for one, expect to pay for two. NCL doesn't publish a single-supplement rule, but its promotion terms speak of "singles paying 200%." Price the solo cabins against a regular cabin before you choose. The **stateroom check** can tell you about a specific cabin number on Jewel.

Free at Sea

For bookings made from November 5, 2025, NCL's package is called **Free at Sea**. Per NCL's Free at Sea page, read October 2026, it includes:

- An **open bar** for guests 21 and over, on board and at Great Stirrup Cay
- **Specialty dining**: four meals on a cruise of nine nights or more, so four on this one
- **Wi-Fi**: 150 minutes

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- A **$50 shore excursion credit** at each port, for the first guest in the cabin

The open bar isn't free of charges. NCL's own Free at Sea flyer (December 2025) says: "Gratuities are $28.50/per person/per day for all Guests 21+. Please note this is the pre-cruise price. The onboard price will vary." For ten nights alone, that's **$285**, on top of the daily service charge. Guests 3 to 20 get soda and juice instead, for $12.50 a day. The **drink calculator** uses the same $28.50. What's included depends on when and how you book, so check your own confirmation.

Connectivity

NCL's Wi-Fi runs on Starlink. Free at Sea includes 150 minutes. Beyond that, NCL's Free at Sea page lists the **Voyage Wi-Fi Pass at $29.99** and the **Streaming Voyage Wi-Fi Pass at $39.99**, each per cabin per day, plus $14.99 a day for each extra device (October 2026). The **internet at sea guide** explains how ship Wi-Fi works.

Section 2 — Day by Day

Each port day has the times from NCL's schedule, the all-aboard time, and a few things to know. The port pages on this site go deeper.

Day 1 — Monday, November 29 — Miami (embarkation)

Ship leaves: 4:00 PM. **Be on board by 3:00 PM.**

- **The terminal.** PortMiami lists Terminal B, "The Pearl of Miami," as NCL's terminal, and Terminal C as one that "serves ships from several cruise lines." No terminal has been assigned for a 2027 sailing yet, so **your eDocs name yours.**
- **Parking.** PortMiami lists Garage B, 1756 N. Cruise Blvd., at $35 a day (effective January 1, 2025). If your eDocs say Terminal C, Garage C is at 1648 N. Cruise Blvd., at $28 a day. Debit cards aren't accepted.
- **Arrival time.** NCL asks guests who've checked in online to arrive at the terminal no later than one hour before their chosen boarding time.

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- **Carry-on.** Keep your passport, medications, a swimsuit and a change of clothes with you. Checked bags can take a while to reach your cabin.

More on the **Miami port page**.

Day 2 — Tuesday, November 30 — Great Stirrup Cay, Bahamas

In port: 7:00 AM to 3:00 PM. **All aboard 2:00 PM.**

This is NCL's own island in the Berry Islands of the Bahamas.

- **The pier.** NCL says a multi-ship pier debuted in December 2025, so guests can walk ashore. CruiseHive reported that it can serve every ship in NCL's family of lines, two at a time. But on the pier's first day, December 28, 2025, Jewel's sister ship Norwegian Gem anchored and tendered while another ship used the pier. So Jewel may dock or may tender. **Check the app** the day before.
- **What's free:** the beaches, loungers and umbrellas, and the Splash Harbor splash pad. The Free at Sea open bar applies on the island.
- **What costs extra:** the **Great Tides Waterpark**, which opened in September 2026, was "from $89" on NCL's excursion page in October 2026. Also cabanas, the Vibe Shore Club day pass, the zipline, and snorkel and paddleboard rentals.
- **Money.** Purchases go on your ship card.

More on the **Great Stirrup Cay port page**.

Day 3 — Wednesday, December 1 — At sea

The first sea day. Book your specialty dinners and any shore excursions you still want, find the spa and the quiet corners, and sleep in if you like.

Day 4 — Thursday, December 2 — Cabo Rojo, Dominican Republic

In port: 9:00 AM to 4:00 PM. **All aboard 3:00 PM.**

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Cabo Rojo is a new cruise port in **Pedernales Province**, in the far southwest of the Dominican Republic. A Caribbean Journal report from September 2023 said it would welcome its first cruise ship that December.

- **What's around it.** NCL's own page says the region is "sparsely populated" and that "there aren't any recommended shopping areas." Plan this day around an NCL Shore Excursion, or a quiet day near the port.
- **Bahía de las Águilas.** NCL calls it "the country's most beautiful beach" and describes it as five miles long. It sits in **Jaragua National Park**, which NCL notes is a UNESCO Biosphere Reserve.
- **Getting there.** The Dominican tourism ministry says you reach it "by an all-terrain vehicle, or by boat from the shores of Cabo Rojo." It also says the beach has "no hotels, shops, or restaurants" and no shade, so bring water and plenty of sun protection. An NCL excursion handles the boat and gets you back in time.
- **Money.** The Dominican peso. Ask before you pay in dollars.
- **Emergency number:** 911. The UK government notes that 911 "does not have full coverage across the country."

This site doesn't have a Cabo Rojo page yet, so this pack doesn't say more than NCL and the sources above do.

Day 5 — Friday, December 3 — Aruba (Oranjestad)

In port: 11:00 AM to 8:00 PM. **All aboard 7:00 PM.**

A late-morning arrival and an evening departure, so you have the afternoon and the sunset.

- **The pier.** Ships dock at the Oranjestad cruise terminal, at the edge of downtown, per our **Aruba port page**.
- **Arikok National Park.** Aruba's tourism office says "nearly 20% of Aruba is a designated National Park," and that visitors "need to purchase a ticket" to enter. No official page gives the entry fee, and travel guides disagree ($11 or $22 a person), so check at the gate. The Aruba Conservation Foundation, which runs the park, lists guided hikes at $25, but they start between 6:00 and 8:00 AM, before your ship arrives. Travel guides also say the park closes in mid-afternoon, so if you go, go straight from the ship.

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- **Money.** The Aruban florin. US dollars are widely taken.
- **Emergency numbers:** 911 for ambulance and fire, **100 for police** (UK government travel advice).
- **Arrival card.** Aruba's online ED card doesn't apply to cruise passengers, per a January 2025 Travel Market Report guide. If NCL asks for any form, it will be in the app.

Day 6 — Saturday, December 4 — Curaçao (Willemstad)

In port: 7:00 AM to 7:00 PM. **All aboard 6:00 PM.**

A long day in a walkable old town.

- **The Queen Emma Bridge.** Curaçao's tourism site says it was built in 1888 and swings open to let ships into the harbor. While it's open, a small ferry called the ponchi carries people across free.
- **Walking.** Our **Curaçao port page** puts the waterfront at 10 to 15 minutes' walk from the cruise piers.
- **Money.** Curaçao's currency is now the **Caribbean guilder (XCG)**, which replaced the Netherlands Antillean guilder on March 31, 2025. The central bank pegs it at 1.79 to the US dollar.
- **Emergency numbers:** 911 for police and fire, **912 for ambulance** (UK government travel advice).
- **Arrival card.** Curaçao's 2019 notice on its online immigration card describes it as required for "any person traveling to Curaçao by air." It says nothing about cruise passengers. Watch the app for anything NCL asks you to fill in.

Day 7 — Sunday, December 5 — At sea

The second sea day. A good day for the Thermal Suite, a show, or a long lunch.

Day 8 — Monday, December 6 — Falmouth, Jamaica

In port: 7:00 AM to 5:00 PM. **All aboard 4:00 PM.**

- **The pier.** Falmouth's deep-water pier takes big ships alongside, per our **Falmouth port page**, and the Georgian old town is right next to it.

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- **Money.** The Jamaican dollar. US dollars are taken in tourist areas.
- **Emergency numbers: 119 for police, 110 for ambulance and fire** (UK government travel advice). The US Embassy in Kingston's after-hours line is 1 (876) 702-6000.
- **Travel advisory.** The US State Department rates Jamaica Level 2, "exercise increased caution" (June 2026). The companion's Alerts tab keeps this current.

Day 9 — Tuesday, December 7 — Grand Cayman (George Town)

In port: 7:00 AM to 5:00 PM. **All aboard 4:00 PM.**

- **It's a tender port.** The ship anchors off George Town, and small boats carry you ashore, per our **Grand Cayman port page**. The last tender back leaves before all-aboard time. The ship announces it, so **listen for it and leave yourself extra time.**
- **If you use a wheelchair or walk with difficulty,** ask NCL about tendering before you book anything ashore.
- **Money.** The Cayman Islands dollar. US dollars are taken.
- **Emergency number:** 911 (UK government travel advice).

Day 10 — Wednesday, December 8 — At sea

The last sea day. Check your onboard account in the app, settle anything you want to dispute, and pack your bags.

Day 11 — Thursday, December 9 — Miami (debarkation)

The ship is due in at 7:00 AM. Keep your passport, medications and a change of clothes with you. If you're flying home, book a flight after midday, because getting off the ship and through customs takes time.

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Section 3 — Pre-Cruise Countdown

Now (more than a year out)

- **Check your documents.** For a round trip from a US port, NCL accepts a valid passport, or a state-certified US birth certificate with a government photo ID. NCL also says it "strongly recommends all guests to obtain a passport." If your passport would expire around the trip, renew it.
- **Buy travel insurance** when you book. Medical care on board is billed to you.
- **Look at a Solo cabin** before a regular one. See **Section 1**.

When NCL opens your bookings

- **Specialty dinners**, if Free at Sea gives you four.
- **Shore excursions.** Cabo Rojo is the day where an organized trip matters most.
- **Great Tides Waterpark** tickets, if you want them.

When NCL opens online check-in

- **Check in** in the NCL app, and choose your boarding time.
- **Book your flight in for Sunday, November 28, 2027.** It's the Sunday after Thanksgiving, so book early.

The week before

- **Fill in the handoff card** in **Section 6** and give it to one person at home.
- **Count down** with the **countdown tool**, if that helps.

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Section 4 — Packing List

This list fits **early December in the southern Caribbean**: warm days, a chance of showers, six port days and three sea days. The **packing lists** page has more.

Documents and money

- **Passport** (or the birth certificate and photo ID NCL allows)
- A copy of your passport, kept somewhere else
- Your insurance policy and its emergency number, printed
- Two cards, kept in different places
- Some small US bills for taxis and tips ashore

Carry-on

- All medications, in their original bottles
- Phone, charger, power bank
- Refillable water bottle
- Swimsuit and a change of clothes

Daytime

- Swimsuits and a cover-up
- Light shirts and shorts
- A light sweater for the air conditioning
- A light rain jacket
- Sunglasses, hat, reef-safe sunscreen

Evenings

NCL's restaurant dress code: "shirts and footwear required," and "swimwear should be saved for the pool." Pack whatever makes you comfortable at dinner within that.

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Footwear

- Walking shoes for Willemstad and Falmouth
- Water shoes for the beaches
- Sandals

Wine

NCL lets you carry on bottles of wine and champagne, but not box wine or other alcohol. Its corkage fee is $15 per 750 ml bottle, waived if you have a drink package.

Section 5 — Budget Breakdown

Prices here were checked in **October 2026**, more than a year before you sail. Use them to plan, and check again before you go. For your own total, the **cruise budget calculator** is set up for this.

Included in an NCL fare

- Your cabin
- Meals at the included restaurants (Azura, Tsar's Palace, the Garden Café, The Great Outdoors, Topsiders, O'Sheehan's)
- The shows in the Stardust Theater
- Pools and the fitness center
- At Great Stirrup Cay: the beaches, loungers and splash pad
- Whatever Free at Sea adds to your booking (see **Section 1**)

What might cost extra

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Item	What we know (October 2026)
Daily service charge	$20 per person per day for cabins up to Club Balcony Suite; $25 for The Haven and suites (bookings from January 1, 2023). For 10 nights, about $200 in a standard cabin. It can be prepaid up to 24 hours before sailing
Drink package service charge	$28.50 per person per day for guests 21 and over with the Free at Sea open bar (NCL's flyer, pre-cruise price; NCL says the onboard price will vary). About $285 for ten nights
Drinks without a package	NCL adds 20% to bar purchases
Specialty dining	$40 to $60 a person cover charge, plus 20%, beyond your Free at Sea meals
Wi-Fi	Beyond Free at Sea's 150 minutes: $29.99 a day per cabin, or $39.99 for streaming; $14.99 a day per extra device
Thermal Suite, Vibe Beach Club	Paid passes
Great Stirrup Cay	Great Tides Waterpark from $89; cabanas and rentals extra
Laundry	Steward service, priced on the form in your cabin; express same-day available
Parking	Garage B, $35 a day (Garage C, $28, if you sail from Terminal C)
Travel insurance	Depends on age and coverage
Hotel the night before	Depends on Miami prices that weekend

Tipping

NCL's daily service charge covers the crew in general. The **cruise tipping calculator** helps if you want to plan anything extra, and **Cruise Tipping 2026** explains the custom.

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Section 6 — Emergency Contacts

Fill this in and give a copy to one person at home before you go. When you’re sailing alone, this card is how they find you.

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FAMILY HANDOFF — IN THE WAKE VOYAGE PACK
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CRUISER:        _____________________
CABIN:          ____________
SHIP:           Norwegian Jewel
LINE:           Norwegian Cruise Line
SAILING:        November 29 – December 9, 2027
FROM:           Miami, Florida, USA (PortMiami)
ITINERARY:      Miami → Great Stirrup Cay (Bahamas) →
                at sea → Cabo Rojo (DR) → Aruba →
                Curaçao → at sea → Falmouth (Jamaica) →
                Grand Cayman → at sea → Miami
DAILY CHECK-IN: I'll message by ______ each evening
                (ship time). No message by ______ ?
                Follow the steps below.

EMERGENCY (24/7):
  US Citizens Abroad — State Dept:
                +1 (888) 407-4747  (from the US/Canada)
                +1 (202) 501-4444  (from abroad)
  To reach someone aboard an NCL ship:
                1-833-810-7963   (from the US/Canada)
                1-321-953-9006   (international)
                (NCL says calls are paid by card)

EMERGENCY NUMBERS ASHORE:
  Miami, FL           – 911
  Great Stirrup Cay   – 911 or 919 (Bahamas)
  Cabo Rojo, DR       – 911 (not full coverage)
  Aruba               – 911 ambulance/fire, 100 police
  Curaçao             – 911 police/fire, 912 ambulance
  Falmouth, Jamaica   – 119 police, 110 ambulance/fire
  Grand Cayman        – 911

US EMBASSIES AND CONSULATES (24/7 emergency lines):
  Bahamas            – Embassy Nassau:
                       242-461-5025, ext 1
  Dominican Republic – Embassy Santo Domingo:
                       (809) 567-7775
  Aruba and Curaçao  – Consulate General Curaçao:
                       +599 (9) 433-2200
                       +1 301-985-8733 (from the US)
  Jamaica and Cayman – Embassy Kingston:
                       1 (876) 702-6000

CRUISER MEDICAL:
  Allergies:    _____________________
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  Medications:  _____________________
  Conditions:   _____________________
  Insurance:    _____________________  policy: ____________

WHERE IS THE SHIP:
  cruisinginthewake.com/tools/ship-tracker.html
_____________________________________________
```

What the person at home should do

If they don’t hear from you by the check-in time:

1. **Don’t panic.** Ship Wi-Fi drops out, and silence usually means no signal.
2. **Wait for the next check-in.** Then try your phone and messages.
3. **Call NCL’s ship number** above. NCL says it’s paid by card.
4. **If it’s serious,** call the State Department: +1 (888) 407-4747. It runs around the clock and works with cruise lines and embassies.
5. **To see where the ship is,** use the **ship tracker**.

The page on **reaching someone at sea** explains how all this works.

Where these numbers come from. The State Department numbers and the Curaçao, Kingston, Nassau and Santo Domingo lines are from each US embassy or consulate’s own website, read October 2026. NCL’s ship number is from NCL’s FAQ. The local emergency numbers are from the UK government’s travel advice. Check them again before you go.

Section 7 — Weather and Seasickness

Weather

Below are typical figures for November 29 to December 9, worked out from five years of weather records (2020 to 2024) for each stop. They’re averages, not a forecast. The companion app shows a real forecast as the dates get close.

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Stop	Typical high	Typical low	Days with rain
Miami	78°F	65°F	20%
Great Stirrup Cay	77°F	74°F	15%
Cabo Rojo	87°F	72°F	16%
Aruba	85°F	79°F	60%
Curaçao	85°F	78°F	58%
Falmouth	83°F	73°F	47%
Grand Cayman	83°F	78°F	42%

“Days with rain” counts any day with more than 1 mm (about 0.04 inch) of rain at that point, so a short shower counts the same as a wet day. Read it as how often you might see rain, not how often a day is spoiled. Cabo Rojo has the warmest afternoons, and Aruba and Curaçao are the most likely to see a shower. Miami is the coolest at night.

These come from Open-Meteo’s historical weather records, at the grid point the records use for each stop. For small islands that point can sit over the water, which keeps the night-time lows close to the highs.

Hurricanes. NOAA says the season ends November 30, the day after you sail. If a late storm threatens, the cruise line can change ports or the order of the days.

Seasickness

Nobody can promise how your body will feel at sea. If you’re prone to seasickness:

- **Pick a cabin low and in the middle of the ship**, where motion is least.
- **Ask your doctor or pharmacist** about meclizine (Bonine), dimenhydrinate (Dramamine) or a prescription scopolamine patch, and try anything new at home first.
- **Ginger and acupressure bands** help some people.
- **Fresh air and a view of the horizon** help most people.
- **The ship’s medical center** can treat seasickness. It bills you, and most US health plans don’t cover care at sea, so check yours.

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Section 8 — Practical Logistics

Phones

- **At sea:** use the ship's Wi-Fi, and turn off cellular data so you don't pay for the ship's network.
- **In port:** every stop on this trip is outside the US. Some US plans include these islands, some charge a daily fee. **Check with your carrier before you go.**

Money

- **Aboard and at Great Stirrup Cay:** charged to your ship account.
- **Cabo Rojo:** the Dominican peso.
- **Aruba:** the Aruban florin; US dollars widely taken.
- **Curaçao:** the Caribbean guilder since 2025; US dollars widely taken.
- **Falmouth:** the Jamaican dollar; US dollars taken in tourist areas.
- **Grand Cayman:** the Cayman Islands dollar; US dollars taken.

Travel advisories (US State Department)

Read October 2026:

- **The Bahamas:** Level 2, "exercise increased caution" (July 2026).
- **Dominican Republic:** Level 2, "exercise increased caution" (June 2025).
- **Aruba:** Level 1, "exercise normal precautions" (August 2026).
- **Curaçao:** Level 1, "exercise normal precautions" (September 2026).
- **Jamaica:** Level 2, "exercise increased caution" (June 2026).
- **Cayman Islands:** Level 1, "exercise normal precautions" (May 2026).

Levels change. The companion app's Alerts tab shows the current level for each, refreshed daily.

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Laundry, smoking, and the rules

- **Laundry.** Not self-service. Use the order form in your cabin; express same-day service is available.
- **Smoking** in your cabin or on your balcony carries a **$250 cleaning charge**. NCL allows cigar smoking in the cigar lounge, cigarettes in the casino for active players, and smoking outdoors on Deck 13, forward, port side.
- **Drinking age:** 21 on sailings from the US.

Accessibility

If you use a wheelchair or a scooter, or need other help, tell NCL when you book. Grand Cayman is a tender port, and Jewel may tender at Great Stirrup Cay too (see **Day 2**), so ask about both. The **accessibility guide** on this site covers more.

Section 9 — The Solo Cruise Rhythm

Ten nights alone at sea has a rhythm, and you get to set it.

- **Pick one anchor a day.** A port walk, a show, a dinner. The rest can stay loose.
- **Eat where it's easy.** The Garden Café buffet and O'Sheehan's are casual, and you eat on your own schedule.
- **Use the sea days.** Day 3, Day 7 and Day 10 are yours: the spa, a book, a long lunch.
- **One message home a day.** Tell your person where you're going ashore, and that you're back aboard.

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Section 10 — Sailing Solo on NCL

- **Solo cabins.** Jewel has Solo Inside, Solo Oceanview and Solo Balcony cabins, where NCL says “double occupancy rates don’t apply.”
- **No Studio Lounge on Jewel.** NCL’s solo lounge comes with Studio cabins, and Jewel has none.
- **Solo meetups.** In 2023 NCL said solo cruisers “can enjoy activities scheduled for single travelers to mix and mingle.” NCL’s current pages don’t say whether that happens on Jewel. On cruise forums, solo travelers describe meetups listed in the ship’s daily schedule on many NCL ships, often in the early evening, and say they’re as good as the people who show up. **Look in the daily schedule on your first day.** Before you go, Cruise Critic’s message boards have a Roll Calls section with a thread for each sailing date, where people on the same cruise can say hello.
- **Excursions.** NCL’s Shore Excursions are an easy way to spend a port day with other people, especially at Cabo Rojo.

Safety, the same as at home: tell someone where you’re going ashore, keep your drink in sight, and be back early.

The **solo cruising hub** has more from people who’ve done it.

Section 11 — First Cruise Notes

If this is your first cruise, the **first-cruise guide** goes deeper. A few things worth knowing ahead:

- **Cabins are small.** Even a balcony cabin is smaller than most hotel rooms.
- **The NCL app runs the week.** Download it and log in before you go.
- **Be back early.** If you’re late on your own, the ship can leave without you.
- **You don’t have to do everything.** Ten nights is long enough to skip things.

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If you like photos, the **cruise tech and photography guide** helps you pack the right gear.

Closing

This pack is a plain read on ten nights: NCL's first Jewel-class ship, two Dutch islands, a new port in the far southwest of the Dominican Republic, Jamaica, Grand Cayman, and NCL's own island at the start. Check the numbers again before you go, set your own pace, and enjoy it.

Share or save. The companion app has a share button. If someone you know is thinking about this cruise, send them the link.

Soli Deo Gloria. All work on this project is offered as a gift to God. The site that produced it is independent: no affiliate links, no commissions, no upsells. If it helped you, that's the whole point.

Last reviewed | 2026-10-11, for a sailing on 2027-11-29. Sailing times and ship facts from NCL's own pages; port facts as noted below |
How facts here are checked | Every fact in this pack is listed with its source in the pack's fact-check file. The sailing's dates, port order and times come from NCL's schedule for this voyage. Ship facts come from NCL's ship page, deck plans, FAQ and press releases, with tonnage, builder and dates from the ship's Wikipedia entry and VesselFinder. Port facts come from NCL, PortMiami, the US State Department and its embassy and consulate sites, the UK government's travel advice, Aruba's and Curaçao's tourism sites, the Central Bank of Curaçao and Sint Maarten, and named travel sites where those had no answer. Weather averages were calculated from Open-Meteo's historical weather records. Where sources disagreed, the pack says so or leaves the number out. |
Accessibility | This pack is written to read straight through on a screen reader: headings in order, small labeled tables, and links named for where they go. If something here is hard for you to use, that's a bug, and we want to hear about it. |

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Sources | Ship: **Norwegian Jewel**; NCL ship page, deck plans, “What’s On Board”, FAQ, Free at Sea and solo pages, and press releases. Ports on this site: **Miami**, **Great Stirrup Cay**, **Aruba**, **Curaçao**, **Falmouth**, **Grand Cayman**. Venues: **Garden Café**, **The Great Outdoors**, **O’Sheehan’s**, **Cagney’s**, **Moderno**, **La Cucina**, **Le Bistro**, **Teppanyaki**, **Chin Chin**, **Vibe Beach Club**. Tools: **drink calculator**, **stateroom check**, **cruise budget calculator**, **cruise tipping calculator**, **ship tracker**, **ship size atlas**. Reference: **solo cruising hub**, **first-cruise guide**, **countdown**, **packing lists**, **internet at sea**, **reaching someone at sea**, **disability at sea**. Articles: **Cruise Tipping 2026**, **cruise tech and photography guide**. |

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